Overview

Getting Started

Chroma is the open-source data infrastructure for AI. It comes with everything you need to get started built-in, and runs on your machine.

Python TypeScript Rust



Chroma







Watch on

For production, Chroma offers **Chroma Cloud** - a fast, scalable, and serverless database-as-a-service. Get started in 30 seconds - $5 in free credits included.

quickly set you up with Chroma.

Chroma Cloud OSS

```
In this directory create a new Python project with Chroma set up.
Use a virtual environment.

Write a small example that adds some data to a collection and queries it.
Do not delete the data from the collection when it's complete.
Run the script when you are done setting up the environment and writing the
script. The output should show what data was ingested, what was the query,
```

See all 28 lines

Install Manually

1 Install

pip poetry uv

```
pip install chromadb
```

2 Create a Chroma Client

Python

```
import chromadb
chroma_client = chromadb.Client()
```

enable efficient retrieval and filtering. You can create a collection with a name:

Python

```
collection = chroma_client.create_collection(name="my_collection")
```

4 Add some text documents to the collection

Chroma will store your text and handle embedding and indexing automatically. You can also customize the embedding model. You must provide unique string IDs for your documents.

Python

```
collection.add(
    ids=["id1", "id2"],
    documents=[
        "This is a document about pineapple",
        "This is a document about oranges"
    ]
)
```

5 Query the collection

You can query the collection with a list of query texts, and Chroma will return the n most similar results. It's that easy!

```
)
print(results)
```

If n_results is not provided, Chroma will return 10 results by default. Here we only added 2 documents, so we set n_results=2.

6 Inspect Results

From the above - you can see that our query about hawaii is semantically most similar to the document about pineapple.

Python

```
{
  'documents': [[
      'This is a document about pineapple',
      'This is a document about oranges'
  ]],
  'ids': [['id1', 'id2']],
  'distances': [[1.0404009819030762, 1.243080496788025]],
  'uris': None,
  'data': None,
  'metadatas': [[None, None]],
  'embeddings': None,
}
```

7 Try it out yourself

What if we tried querying with “This is a document about florida”? Here is a full example.

```
# switch \`create_collection\` to \`get_or_create_collection\` to avoi
collection = chroma_client.get_or_create_collection(name="my_collectio

# switch \`add\` to \`upsert\` to avoid adding the same documents ever
```

See all 21 lines

Next steps

In this guide we used Chroma's **in-memory client** for simplicity. It starts a Chroma server in-memory, so any data you ingest will be lost when your program terminates. You can use the **persistent client** or run Chroma in **client-server mode** if you need data persistence.

- Learn how to **Deploy Chroma** to a server
- Join Chroma's **Discord Community** to ask questions and get help
- Follow Chroma on **X (@trychroma)** for updates

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